January 29, 1959

MEMO TO: Mr. A. Padegs

SUBJECT: Nomenclature of STRETCH Communications Tape Systems

I have noticed that in some of your memos you refer to STRETCH Tape systems as being "with byte converter" and "without byte converter". While this does the job of differentiating between the two contemplated system, it implies that the total hardware difference is byte conversion. Since this is not true, I suggest that we attempt to find more suitable names for the two contemplated tape systems.

You may be interested in the following hardware statistics on the original STRETCH Tape Adapter.

Basic TAU	50%
Byte Converter	15%
CE Controls	5%
Unit Signal	4%
Forward Space & Backspace File	2%
ECC Operation	2%
Control Instruction	3%
Locate Instruction	4%
Dual Density	1/2%
Normal Exchange Requirements & Miscellaneous	14 1/2%

The "with byte converter" system performs the following functions that the "without byte converter" system will not handle.

Byte Conversion
Dual Density Operation
ECC Operation
Forward Space Block
Forward Space File
Backspace File
Locate to Eight Units vs Two Units
Unit Signal Indicator for Eight Units

There are probably several suitable choices of names but I think that this choice is probably a function of the planning group.

J. D. Calvert

JDC:ps
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